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January 29, 1964

SUPERSEDING
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January 28, 1963

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

# TACKER, STAPLE, (COMPRESSION TYPE, MANUALLY OPERATED), AND STAPLE, TACKER

*This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.*

## 1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. The staple tackers covered by this specification are of the manually-operated compression type, used to drive preformed staples through an object or piece of material into another. The tacker staples are of the preformed type, cemented together in strip form for use in the tackers (see 6.1).

1.1.1 *Federal specification coverage.* Federal specifications do not include all varieties of the commodity as indicated by the title of the specification, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover only those generally used by the Federal Government.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Tackers.* The compression-type tackers covered by this specification shall be of the following types as specified (see 6.2):

Type I.—Medium duty, to accommodate type I staples.
Type II.—Heavy duty, to accommodate type II staples.

1.2.2 *Staples.* The staples covered by this specification shall be of the following types and sizes as specified (see 6.2):

Type I.—Medium duty (see figure 1).
Size 3.—Leg length 3/16 inch.
Size 4.—Leg length 1/4 inch.
Size 5.—Leg length 5/16 inch.

Type II.—Heavy duty (see figure 2).
Size 4.—Leg length 1/4 inch.
Size 5.—Leg length 5/16 inch.
Size 6.—Leg length 3/8 inch.
Size 8.—Leg length 1/2 inch.

## 2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or requests for proposals, form a part of this specification:

*Federal Specification:*

PPP-B-636—Box, Fiberboard.

*Federal Standards:*

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

FSC 5120, 5315



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(*Federal Government activities may obtain* copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

*Military Specification*:

MIL-H-15424—Hand Tools; Packaging of.

*Military Standards:*

MIL-STD-105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

MIL-STD-130—Identification Marking of U. S. Military Property.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

## 3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 **Material.** Material shall be as hereinafter specified. Material not definitely specified shall be of good commercial quality suitable for the purpose intended. Material shall be free from defects and imperfections which might affect the serviceability of the finished product, and shall meet the performance requirements of this specification.

3.2 **Design and construction.** The tackers shall be designed for fastening pierceable materials such as paper, cloth, etc., to penetrable materials such as wood, composition board, etc., by the use of preformed staples in strip form. The tackers shall perform efficiently when operated with one hand. After each staple is driven to its intended depth, the operating handle shall automatically return to its starting position. The feeding mechanism shall operate automatically so as to feed each successive staple beneath the plunger until the last staple on the strip is used; a positive stop shall be provided to prevent the feeding mechanism from being struck by the staple driver. The tacker shall be either of the jam-free type or be so designed that in the event jamming should occur, the jammed staples can be removed either manually without the aid of hand tools or with a tool furnished by the manufacturer with each tacker. The tacker shall operate with either hand. The tacker shall be capable of driving a staple to within 1/4 inch from a vertical surface at its front and within 7/16-inch at each side. All parts of each make and model of tacker shall be interchangeable, and repair parts shall be made available for Government procurement. Each tacker shall consist essentially of a frame with a handgrip (see 3.2.4), a handle (see 3.2.4), a staple guide (see 3.2.5), a staple follower block and a spring to hold the staples tight, a staple driver (see 3.2.2) attached to a ram or plunger, a spring compressing and actuating mechanism, a vertical chute (see 3.2.6), and fasteners (see 3.2.3).

3.2.1 *Springs.* Springs shall be made of spring steel and shall be heat-treated in such a manner as to provide for efficient functioning of the tacker. Springs that require attachment to other parts shall be designed to prevent a bending fatigue point which with repeated flexing would tend to rupture the spring.

3.2.2 *Staple driver.* The staple driver shall be made of spring steel or other comparable steel, and through-hardened to not less than 48 on the Rockwell C scale.

3.2.3 *Fasteners.* Except for the handle hinge pin, fasteners shall be made of steel, iron, or brass. The handle hinge pin shall be made of solid steel and shall be not less than 5/32-inch at the bearing surface. Hollow-type fasteners are acceptable.



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3.2.4 *Handle and handgrip.* The handle and handgrip portion of the tool shall be made of steel, iron, or zinc alloy, except that a plastic component may be included as a component of the handgrip. The handle and handgrip shall provide a safe and comfortable grip which shall be smoothed, rounded, or provided with a cushion grip made of rubber, plastic, or similar material.

3.2.5 *Staple guide.* The guide member on which the staples slide into the driving position, shall be made of metal. The width of the guide portion shall be not more than 0.454 inch so as to accommodate the inside dimension of 1/2-inch overall-width staples.

3.2.6 *Vertical chute.* The surfaces of the vertical chute, through which the staple is guided, shall be made of steel and shall be either through-hardened or case-hardened.

3.3 Surface finish. All surfaces, upon which the staple comes into contact while feeding through, or when being ejected, shall be sufficiently smooth to provide efficient operation.

3.4 Cleaning and applied finish.

3.4.1 *Cleaning.* All metal surfaces shall be thoroughly cleaned, and free from rust, scale, dirt, oil, grease, moisture, and other material which might affect the finish to be applied.

3.4.2 *Applied finish.* Except for corrosion-resisting metal parts, all exterior metal surfaces shall be either painted or plated. If painted, at least two coats shall be applied in accordance with good commercial practice. The color of the paint shall be the manufacturer's standard. If plated, the plating shall be cadmium, chromium, zinc, or nickel. Plating shall be applied in accordance with good commercial practice.

3.5 Marking. Each tacker and each box of staples shall be marked with the manufacturer's name, or brand name, or trademark, of such known character that the source of manufacture can be readily identified; also the leg length of the staples shall be marked on the box of staples. The tacker marking shall be permanent. For military procurement, identification marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-130.

3.6 Type I, medium duty tacker. The type I medium duty tacker shall operate efficiently with all sizes of type I staples covered by this specification. The tacker shall accommodate a strip of at least 140 staples. The vertical chute through which the staples are ejected shall be not less than 0.033 inch, nor more than 0.037 inch in width; and not less than 0.516 inch, nor more than 0.528 inch in length. The height of the staple guide shall be at least 0.306 inch, and the height inside the horizontal chute shall be at least 0.346 inch so as to accommodate size 5 staples. The tackers shall comply with the applicable requirements of section 4.

3.7 Type II, heavy duty tacker. The type II heavy duty tacker shall operate efficiently with all sizes of type II staples covered by this specification. The tacker shall accommodate a strip of at least 84 staples. The vertical chute through which the staples are ejected, shall be not less than 0.053 inch, nor more than 0.057 inch in width; and not less than 0.516 inch, nor more than 0.528 inch in length. The height of the staple guide (see 3.2.5), shall be at least 0.494 inch, and the height inside the horizontal chute shall be at least 0.533 inch so as to accommodate size 8 staples. The tackers shall comply with the applicable requirements of section 4.

3.8 Type I, medium duty staples. The type I medium duty staples shall be in accordance with the dimensions shown in figure 1. The staples shall be preformed to a U-shape, having square inside corners and a flat top. The staples shall be cemented together in strip form, each strip consisting of 140 staples. The cement shall be applied smoothly and shall set in such a manner



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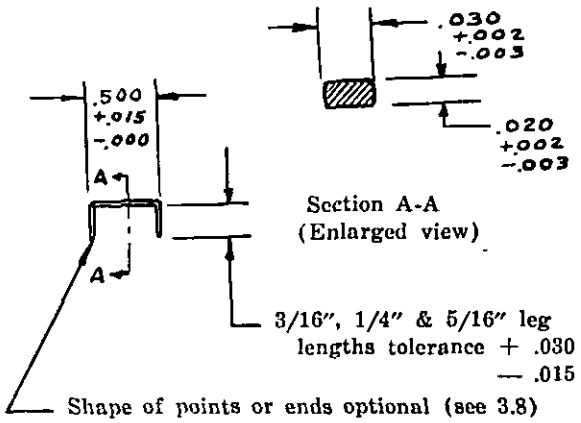



FIGURE 1.—Type I, medium duty staple(s).

that the surfaces of the strips shall be free from tackiness. The inside dimension of the U-shaped cemented staple strip shall be not less than 0.455 inch so as to insure easy sliding of the staples through the tacker. The staple points or ends shall be of such design that the staples will meet the tests in section 4. The steel wire shall be so tempered as to provide penetration of the staple to a firm seat without buckling or fracturing. The leg length(s) of the staples shall be in accordance with the size(s) specified in the invitation for bid. The staples shall be tinned, galvanized, or made equally corrosion resistant.

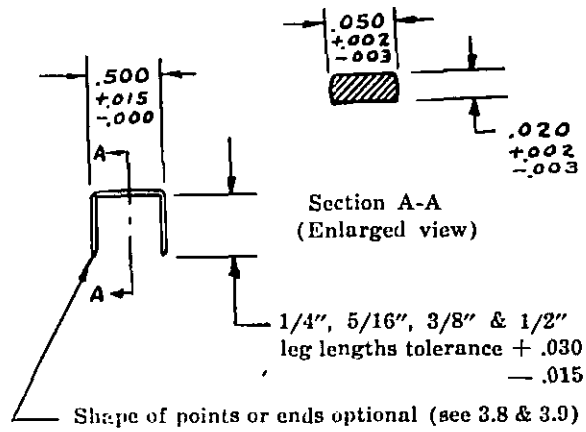



FIGURE 2.—Type II, heavy duty staple(s).

**3.9 Type II, heavy duty staples.** The type II heavy duty staples shall be in accordance with 3.8, except that the staples shall be in accordance with figure 2, and shall be cemented together in strips of 84.

**3.10 Workmanship.** Workmanship shall be first class in every respect. The tacker shall be free from burrs, sharp edges, and other defects which might affect safety or serviceability.

## 4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

**4.1 Responsibility for inspection.** Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

**4.2 Sampling for lot acceptance.**

4.2.1 *Inspection lot.* All tackers of the same type, or all boxes of staples of the same type and size presented at one time shall be considered a lot for purposes of acceptance inspection and tests.

4.2.2 *Sampling for inspection.*

4.2.2.1 *Sampling for visual and dimensional examination.* A random sample of tackers, or boxes of staples shall be selected in accordance with table I from each inspection lot of material offered for inspection of visual and dimensional characteristics with lot acceptance based on the sampling inspection requirements in accordance with table I, and MIL-STD-105.



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TABLE I.—*Sampling for visual and dimensional examination AQL (approx.) = 1.5 percent defective*

| Number of tackers, or boxes of staples in inspection lot | Reference MIL-STD-105 |
|---|---|
| 40 and under | Inspection level III |
| 41 to 300 | Inspection level II |
| 301 and over | Inspection level I |

4.2.3 *Sampling for lot acceptance test.* A random sample of tackers of the same type or boxes of staples of the same type and size, shall be selected from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection level shall be S-5 with an acceptable quality level of 1.5 percent defective. However, the sample size shall be the number associated with the letter in the table and the acceptance number shall be zero until the AQL permits one or greater.

4.3 Visual and dimensional examination. Each of the sample tackers, or boxes of staples selected in accordance with table I shall be visually and dimensionally examined to verify compliance with this specification. The examination of tackers shall be conducted as specified in table II, and the examination of boxes of staples as specified in table III. Any tacker or any box of staples containing one or more visual or dimensional defects shall be rejected, and if the number of defective tackers or boxes of staples in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.3.1 *Lot acceptance tests.*

4.3.1.1 *Testing of sample tackers for lot acceptance tests.* Each of the sample type I medium duty tackers selected in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be tested in accordance with 4.4.1 and 4.4.2 to verify compliance with this specification. Each of the sample type II heavy duty tackers selected in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be tested in accordance with 4.4.1 and 4.4.3 to verify compliance with this specification. Any sample tacker which does not meet the requirements for any of these characteristics shall be rejected, and if the number of nonconforming tackers in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

TABLE II.—*Classification of tacker defects in accordance with MIL-STD-105.*

| Categories | Defects |
|---|---|
| *Critical:* | None defined. |
| *Major:* | |
| 101 | Type and size not as specified (see 1.2.1). |
| 102 | Handle does not return automatically to starting position (see 3.2). |
| 103 | Feed mechanism does not work automatically (see 3.2). |
| 104 | Jammed staples cannot be easily removed (see 3.2). |
| 105 | Not capable of driving a staple within 1/4-inch of vertical surface at its front or within 7/16-inch at each side (see 3.2). |
| 106 | Springs not designed to prevent a bending fatigue point (see 3.2.1). |
| 107 | Handle hinge pin bearing surface less than 5/32-inch (see 3.2.3). |
| 108 | Handle and handgrip do not provide a safe and comfortable grip (see 3.2.4). |
| 109 | The staple guide member is more than 0.454-inch in width (see 3.2.5). |
| 110 | The vertical chute through which the staple is guided is unhardened (see 3.2.6). |
| 111 | Surface finish not as specified (see 3.3). |
| 112 | Does not accommodate a strip of 140 staples or 84 staples as applicable, (see 3.6 and 3.7). |
| 113 | The vertical chute or staple guide is not within the applicable specified dimensions (see 3.6 and 3.7). |
| 114 | Materials not as specified. |
| *Minor:* | |
| 201 | Cleaning not as specified (see 3.4.1). |
| 202 | Applied finish not as specified (see 3.4.2). |
| 203 | Marking not as specified (see 3.5). |

4.3.1.2 *Testing of sample boxes of staples for lot acceptance tests.* Each of the sample boxes of type I medium duty staples selected in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be tested in



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accordance with 4.5.1 to verify compliance with this specification. Each of the sample boxes of type II heavy duty staples shall be tested in accordance with 4.5.2 to verify compliance with this specification. Any sample box of staples which does not meet the requirements shall be rejected, and if the number of nonconforming boxes of staples exceeds the number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

TABLE III.—*Classification of staple defects in accordance with MIL-STD-105*

| Categories | Defects |
|---|---|
| *Critical:* | None defined. |
| *Major:* | |
| 101 | Staples not of the leg length (size) or other specified dimensions and tolerances (see 1.2.2 and figs. 1 and 2). |
| 102 | Not cemented together in strips of 140 staples or 84 staples as applicable (see 3.8 and 3.9). |
| 103 | Staples do not have square inside corners or a flat top (see 3.8 and 3.9). |
| 104 | Staple strips not free from tackiness (see 3.7). |
| 105 | The inside dimension of the U-shape is less than 0.455-inch (see 3.8 and 3.9). |
| 106 | Staples not resistant to corrosion (see 3.8 and 3.9). |
| *Minor:* | |
| 201 | Boxes of staples not marked as specified (see 3.5). |

4.4 Testing of tackers.

4.4.1 *Hardness test of staple driver.* The staple driver of each sample tacker shall be tested on a Rockwell C scale to determine conformance with 3.2.2.

4.4.2 *Performance test for type I, medium duty tackers.* Each sample type medium duty tacker shall be tested for performance as follows: A full strip of 140 type I, size 5 staples (with 5/16-inch leg length) shall be placed in the tacker, and 140 tacking operations shall be performed by driving the staples into a clear piece of finished Douglas fir lumber having approximately 15 percent moisture content. The tacker shall be held firmly against the test lumber and operated with one hand. The test lumber shall be rigidly supported. At least 133 staples shall be driven to full penetration; that is, the underside of the top of the staple shall come into contact with the test lumber.

4.4.3 *Performance test for type II, heavy duty tackers.* Each sample type II heavy duty tacker shall be tested for performance as follows: A full strip of 84, type II, size 8 staples (with 1/2-inch leg length) shall be placed in the tacker and 84 tacking operations shall be performed by driving the staples into a clear piece of finished Douglas fir lumber having approximately 15 percent moisture content. The tacker shall be held firmly against the test lumber and operated with one hand. The test lumber shall be rigidly supported. At least 79 staples shall be driven to full penetration; that is, the underside of the staple shall come into contact with the test lumber.

4.5 Performance testing of staples.

4.5.1 *Type I, medium duty staples.* Each sample box of type I medium duty staples shall be performance tested as follows: One full strip of 140 cemented staples shall be removed from each sample box. (Note: Each box shall contain 36 strips (see 5.1) ). One hundred and forty tacking operations shall be performed with each strip of staples by driving the staples into a clear piece of finished Douglas fir lumber, with the use of a type I medium duty tacker. At least 133 staples from each strip shall be driven to full penetration without buckling, fracturing, or other defect. The sample strip shall be considered as nonconforming if 133 staples are not driven to full penetration.

4.5.2 *Type II, heavy duty staples.* Each sample box of type II heavy duty staples shall be performance tested in accordance



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with 4.5.1 except for the following: One full strip of 84 staples shall be removed from each box. (Note: Each box shall contain 60 strips (see 5.1) ). Eighty-four tacking operations shall be performed with each strip and at least 79 staples shall be driven to full penetration with the use of a type II heavy duty tacker. The sample strip shall be considered as nonconforming if 79 staples are not driven to full penetration.

4.6 Inspection of preparation for delivery. Unless otherwise specified, inspection to determine compliance with preparation for delivery requirements shall be accomplished in accordance with MIL-H-14524, and section 5 herein.

## 5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(Civil agencies should refer to Fed. Std. No. 102 for definitions and applications of the various levels of packaging protection for supplies and equipment.)

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 *Level A.*

5.1.1.1 *Tacker.* Level A cleaning, preservation, and packaging shall be in accordance with level A of MIL-H-15424.

5.1.1.2 *Staples.* Thirty-six strips of type I staples (5040 staples maximum, 5000 minimum) or sixty strips of type II staples (5040 staples maximum, 5000 minimum) shall be packaged in a paperboard box in accordance with the contractor's commercial practice.

5.1.2 *Level C.*

5.1.2.1 *Tacker.* Level C cleaning, preservation, and packaging shall be in accordance with the contractor's commercial practice.

5.1.2.2 *Staples.* Staples shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1.2.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 *Level A.*

5.2.1.1 *Tacker.* Level A packing shall be in accordance with level A of MIL-H-15424.

5.2.1.2 *Staples.* Type I or type II staples, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in the most compact manner in a snug-fitting, fiberboard shipping container conforming to class 2, V3c or V3s, style RSC of PPP-B-636. Weight of contents of each shipping container shall not exceed 65 pounds. Each shipping container shall be closed, waterproofed by means of tape, and reinforced with flat steel strapping or tape banding, in accordance with the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.2 *Level B.*

5.2.2.1 *Tacker.* Level B packing shall be in accordance with level B of MIL-H-15424.

5.2.2.2 *Staples.* Type I or type II staples, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in the most compact manner in a snug-fitting, fiberboard shipping container conforming to type I or II, class 1, style RSC of PPP-B-636. Weight of contents of each shipping container shall not exceed 65 pounds. All flaps of the fiberboard shipping container shall be securely sealed with an adhesive commercially used for the specific product being packed by application throughout the entire area of contact between the flaps, or by a combination of metal stitching the bottom flaps and sealing the top flaps with adhesive.

5.2.3 *Level C.* Tackers, cleaned, preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1, or type I or II staples, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination. Containers shall be in accordance with the rules or regulations of carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.



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5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 *Military requirements.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 **Intended use.** The medium duty staple tacker is intended to be used as a hand tool for driving preformed staples with 3/16, 1/4, and 5/16 inch leg lengths; the tacker and staples are used for mounting or fastening of posters, labels, tags, building paper, etc. Type II heavy duty tacker and type II heavy duty staples are used for fastening thick materials such as ceiling tile, rug pads, insulation, etc., or for fastening materials which are hard to pierce.

6.2 **Ordering data.** Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(*b*) Quantity and type of tackers required (see 1.2.1).
(*c*) Quantity of boxes, and type of staples required (see 1.1.2 and 5.1).
(*d*) Size of staples required (see 1.2.2).
(*e*) Applicable levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(*f*) Additional marking, if required (see 5.3).

6.3 **Transportation description.** Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Tacker, staple:

*Rail:*

Staplers or tackers, hand.
Carload minimum weight 30,000 pounds.

*Motor:*

Stapling machines (staplers), hand powered.
Truckload minimum weight 24,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

Staple, tacker:

*Rail:*

Staples, not otherwise indexed by name, galvanized or tinned.
Carload minimum weight 40,000 pounds.

*Motor:*

Staple, not otherwise indexed, galvanized or tinned.
Truckload minimum weight 40,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

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